COMPLIANCE

⚠ CRITICAL

ACCESSIBILITY LAWSUIT FILED

A disability advocacy group has filed a formal legal complaint. Your product does not meet WCAG 2.1 AA standards, making it inaccessible to users with visual impairments. Legal costs begin immediately, regardless of the eventual outcome.

Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1 AA is a legal requirement in the EU (European Accessibility Act, enforced from 2025), UK, US (ADA), and many other jurisdictions. Common failures include missing alt text on images, insufficient colour contrast ratios, keyboard navigation gaps, missing form labels, and inaccessible custom components. The DevOps approach is to integrate automated accessibility testing into the CI pipeline using tools such as axe-core, Lighthouse, or Pa11y — these catch 30–40% of issues automatically. The remaining issues require manual testing with screen readers (NVDA, VoiceOver, JAWS). Accessibility audits should be a regular part of the definition of done, not a post-launch compliance exercise. Retrofit cost is typically 5–10× higher than building in from the start.

Accessibility is a legal requirement in most jurisdictions. Retrofitting it is ten times harder than building it in from the start.

TEAM DISCUSSION

When was your last accessibility audit? Do you test with screen readers and keyboard-only navigation in your CI pipeline?